

Unit 1: In Search of Adventure

ENGLISH UNIT PLAN | IGNITE ENGLISH, UNIT 1

Duration	6 weeks (8 September to 17 October)
Timetable	5 to 6 lessons per week, 1 hour each
Core text	Ignite English, Unit 1: In Search of Adventure (pp. 10 to 35)
Essential question	What drives people to seek out adventure?
Summative task	Common Task 1: the opening to an adventure story (Coef. 2)

Unit overview

Students explore the conventions of adventure writing across fiction, poetry and literary non-fiction, using the Ignite anthology as the spine. They learn the structure of the Hero's Journey, study how writers build character, setting, suspense and voice, and apply these techniques in their own writing. The unit builds towards Common Task 1: writing the opening to an adventure story from a picture prompt. Real-life adventurers, a class debate and an adventure skit round out the unit and give students authentic reasons to read, write, speak and perform.

Learning objectives

Reading: Understand, reproduce and apply the conventions of an adventure story. Read closely to see how writers create character, suspense and tension.

Writing: Write the opening to an adventure story using the conventions of the genre. Use dialogue and characterization effectively. Develop descriptive writing and control language to build suspense.

Vocabulary: Build and use adventure-related vocabulary and secure the spelling of unit words.

Language: Coordinating and subordinating conjunctions; complete sentences; constructing and punctuating dialogue; commas and semi-colons; fronted adverbials; sentence variety for effect.

Assessment overview

Assessment	When	Weighting
Common Task 1: opening to an adventure story (picture prompt)	Week 5 (common week)	Coef. 2, summative
Adventure vocabulary tests (x2)	Weeks 3 and 6	Formative
Reading comprehension (short and long answer)	Week 6	Formative
Hero's Journey flow diagram	Week 1	Formative
Adventure skit performance	Week 6	Formative
Debate: are dangerous pursuits worth the risk?	Week 6	Formative (oral)
Spelling bee	Week 6	Formative

Resources

- Ignite English textbook, Unit 1 (pp. 10 to 35), including all extracts: Epic of Gilgamesh (Booker), The Hobbit (Tolkien), Bone (Jeff Smith), In the Polar Regions (Bradfield), Robinson Crusoe (Defoe), Nation (Pratchett), Adventures in Mind (Dawe), Captain Scott's journal, EVA 23 (Parmitano), Simon Jenkins' column, The Lost City of Z (Grann), Four Corners (Salak).
- Hero's Journey video: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Hhk4N9AOoCA>
- Adventure vocabulary wall / word bank and weekly spelling lists.
- Picture prompt for Common Task 1 (chosen by the teacher, approved by the coordinator).

Weekly plan

Week 1 (8 to 12 Sept): Launching Adventure and the Hero's Journey

Ignite: Unit opener pp. 10 to 11; Section 1 pp. 12 to 13.

Focus: Establish the unit, explore what drives adventure, and learn the structure of the Hero's Journey.

- L1 Unit launch. Explore the opener image and the Mick Conefrey interview (pp. 10 to 11). Discuss the most adventurous thing students have done and why people seek adventure. Begin the adventure vocabulary wall.
- L2 The Hero's Journey (p. 12). Introduce the stages: call to adventure, into the unknown, trials and tests, the final challenge, reward and return. Watch the Hero's Journey video. Discuss whether known stories and films follow this pattern.
- L3 Epic of Gilgamesh (p. 13, Christopher Booker extract). Read and map Gilgamesh onto the Hero's Journey stages. Discuss the earliest adventure story.
- L4 Grammar: coordinating and subordinating conjunctions (p. 13). Use conjunctions to compare and contrast two adventure stories (Activity 4).
- L5 Create a Hero's Journey flow diagram with examples from students' own reading and films (Activity 2). Quick low-stakes quiz on the stages.
- L6 Flex: extended paragraph tracing a familiar story's hero's journey using conjunctions, or catch-up.

Language and vocabulary: Coordinating and subordinating conjunctions; complete sentences. Adventure word bank and spelling list 1.

Week 2 (15 to 19 Sept): The Call to Adventure: Character, Setting and Dialogue

Ignite: Section 2 pp. 14 to 15 (The Hobbit).

Focus: How writers build expectations through character and setting, and how dialogue reveals character.

- L1 Read The Hobbit extract (pp. 14 to 15). Explore how the call to adventure pulls Bilbo from his ordinary life.
- L2 Characterization: what we learn about Gandalf from appearance and speech, and our impression of Bilbo from what he says, does and thinks (Activities 1 to 2). Introduce 'show, don't tell'.
- L3 Grammar: punctuating dialogue. Quotation marks, capitalization, end punctuation inside speech, new speaker on a new line (Activity 4). Practise correcting and writing dialogue.
- L4 Writing: a call-to-adventure scene in which a stranger brings a challenge to an ordinary character, using description and correctly punctuated dialogue.
- L5 Progress check: build a class list of tips for an effective adventure opening (dialogue, action, description, punctuation). Peer feedback on scenes.
- L6 Flex: redraft the scene from feedback; short reading comprehension on the extract.

Language and vocabulary: Dialogue punctuation: quotation marks, capitalization, end punctuation, new speaker on a new line.

Week 3 (22 to 26 Sept): Heroes and Voice

Ignite: Section 3 pp. 16 to 17 (Bone); Section 6 pp. 24 to 25 (Adventures in Mind).

Focus: Characterization through action and image, brave versus reluctant heroes, and first-person voice.

- L1 Bone graphic novel (pp. 16 to 17). How dialogue, action and images build characterization. Who is the hero? Evidence from the extract.
- L2 Predict and create: what happens next; write a script for the next page with description, dialogue and sound effects (Activity 3). Stretch: recast Fone Bone as brave or reluctant.
- L3 First-person voice (pp. 24 to 25, Heather Dawe). First versus third person and the effect on the reader.
- L4 Writing: rewrite a moment in first person and discuss how it changes tension and closeness. Optional short oral presentation on characterization.
- L5 Vocabulary test 1 and games or quizzes on adventure vocabulary and the Hero's Journey. Spelling check.
- L6 Flex: oral presentation on characterization, or catch-up.

Language and vocabulary: First-person and third-person narrative voice. Vocabulary test 1.

Week 4 (29 Sept to 3 Oct): Suspense, Tension and Description

Ignite: Section 5 pp. 20 to 23 (Robinson Crusoe, Nation); Section 4 pp. 18 to 19 (In the Polar Regions).

Focus: Creating suspense and tension, descriptive imagery, and punctuation and sentence structure for effect.

- L1 Robinson Crusoe (pp. 20 to 21). The footprint. How Defoe builds suspense through sentence structure, commas, conjunctions, semi-colons and punctuation that mirrors thought (Activity 3).
 - L2 Nation by Terry Pratchett (pp. 22 to 23). Compare how the two extracts create tension: events, thoughts and actions, punctuation and paragraphing (Activity 4).
 - L3 In the Polar Regions (pp. 18 to 19, Elizabeth Bradfield). Metaphor, extended metaphor and imagery of danger; how the poet conveys the dangers of exploration.
 - L4 Craft: sentence variety for tension. Short sentences for impact, longer sentences to build; commas, semi-colons and ellipsis. Model a suspense paragraph together.
 - L5 Writing: an unexpected-encounter scene in which a character discovers something that changes everything, with strong setting, suspense and controlled punctuation. This feeds Common Task 1.
 - L6 Flex: peer review and redraft; short comprehension on Robinson Crusoe or Nation.
- Language and vocabulary:** Commas, semi-colons and ellipsis; sentence variety for tension.

Week 5 (6 to 10 Oct): Common Task 1: The Opening to an Adventure Story

Ignite: Common assessment week. Coefficient 2.

Focus: Plan, draft and write the assessed opening from a shared picture prompt.

- L1 Recap the conventions of a strong opening: the call to adventure, character and setting, dialogue, suspense and controlled punctuation. Reveal the picture prompt. Brainstorm ideas.
- L2 Model and plan. Model an opening from a different image, then plan character, setting, the inciting moment and the hook.
- L3 Draft the opening under Common Task conditions. Administered in the common week across all classes.
- L4 Self-evaluate and redraft using the opening-tips checklist, the Magic Wand Test and the Resolution Test. Edit dialogue punctuation and sentence variety.
- L5 Final fair copy and submission of Common Task 1 (Coef. 2).
- L6 Flex: completion buffer; early finishers extend or illustrate their opening.

Language and vocabulary: Consolidation and editing of conjunctions, dialogue punctuation and sentence variety.

Week 6 (13 to 17 Oct): Real-Life Adventurers, Debate and Skit

Ignite: Section 7 pp. 26 to 29 (Scott, EVA 23); Section 8 pp. 30 to 31 (Simon Jenkins); Section 9 pp. 32 to 35 (optional comprehension).

Focus: Non-fiction adventure through diaries and blogs, oral debate, performance and consolidation.

- L1 Captain Scott's journal (p. 27). Personal voice, how Scott portrays Oates, and how tension is built. Fronted adverbials.
- L2 Luca Parmitano's EVA 23 blog (pp. 28 to 29). How he builds tension; vocabulary; fronted adverbials and organizational features. Compare the diary and the blog.
- L3 Worth the Risk? (pp. 30 to 31, Simon Jenkins). Read and summarize his view, examine his examples, and decide whether they are persuasive.
- L4 Structured debate: should adventure sports join the P.E. curriculum? Use open questions, argue for and against, and vote (Section 8 steps).
- L5 Adventure skit performance. Groups perform a short skit that incorporates the Hero's Journey stages. Peer rating.
- L6 Flex: reading comprehension test using the Section 9 extracts (The Lost City of Z, Four Corners), or spelling bee, vocabulary test 2 and unit reflection.

Language and vocabulary: Fronted adverbials and organizational features. Vocabulary test 2 and spelling bee.

Language and SPAG scope

Week	Language and SPAG focus	Applied in
1	Coordinating and subordinating conjunctions; complete sentences	Gilgamesh comparison sentences
2	Dialogue punctuation, quotation marks, capitalization, end punctuation	Call-to-adventure scene
3	First-person and third-person narrative voice	First-person rewrite

Week	Language and SPAG focus	Applied in
4	Commas, semi-colons, ellipsis; sentence variety for tension	Unexpected-encounter scene
5	Editing and consolidation of all of the above	Common Task 1
6	Fronted adverbials; organizational features	Diary and blog analysis, debate

Differentiation

Support: sentence starters and modelled examples for each writing task; the Ignite glossaries and word banks; graphic organisers for the Hero's Journey and for planning; paired reading of extracts.

Stretch: recast characters as brave or reluctant (Bone); write in the style of Pratchett's Nation; extend the opening into a full scene; take on chair or summariser roles in the debate.

Common Task 1 brief

Task: Write the opening to an adventure story based on the picture prompt.

Conditions: In-class, administered in the common week (Week 5) across all classes. The prompt is chosen by the teacher and approved by the coordinator.

Success criteria: a clear inciting incident or call to adventure; a defined character and setting; at least one line of correctly punctuated dialogue; controlled sentence variety and punctuation to build interest; accurate spelling of unit vocabulary.

Weighting: Coefficient 2.